“Śrī Caitanya-caritāmṛta”

Madhya-līlā

Chapter 15

Śrī Caitanya’s Feast at Sārvabhauma’s House

(translated from the Bengali for this edition)

1 While taking His meal at Sārvabhauma’s house, Gaura accepted Amogha, who had reviled Him, and so made plain that He is subject to His devotees.

2 Glory, glory to Śrī Caitanya! Glory to Nityānanda! Glory to Advaitacandra! Glory to all the devotees of Gaura!

3 Glory to the listeners of the *Śrī Caitanya-caritāmṛta*, for whom the *Caitanya-caritāmṛta* is the treasure of their lives!

4 In this way Mahāprabhu stayed in Nīlācala with His devotees, joyfully dancing and singing.

5 In that first year He went to see Jagannātha; He danced and sang, fell prostrate, bowed down and offered prayers.

6 When the *upala-bhoga* began, He would come out of the temple, meet Haridāsa, and return to His own dwelling.

7 Sitting at home, the Lord would chant the Holy Name, and Advaita would come and worship Him.

8 Advaita offered Him fragrant water to wash His feet and to sip, and smeared fragrant sandalwood paste over all His limbs.

9 He put a garland around the Lord's neck and placed *tulasī* buds on His head; then he bowed at His feet and offered prayers with joined palms.

10 Taking whatever flowers and *tulasī* were left on the worship plate, the Lord worshiped the Ācārya with them.

11 He recited the *mantra* "Whoever You are, that You are — obeisance to You," and made the Ācārya laugh with sounds made with His mouth.

12 So They paid obeisance to one another, and again and again the Ācārya invited the Lord to a meal.

13 The story of the Ācārya's invitations is wonderful, and Vṛndāvana dāsa has described it in detail.

14 To tell it again would be repetition, so I have not described it. The other devotees also invited the Lord.

15 Day after day there was a festival in one devotee's home after another, and all the devotees ate there with the Lord.

16 For four months all the devotees stayed with Mahāprabhu and watched Jagannātha's various festivals with great joy.

17 On the festival of Kṛṣṇa's birth comes Nanda's great celebration. That day the Lord and all the devotees dressed as cowherds.

18 Carrying a yoke of yogurt and milk on His shoulder, the Lord came to the festival grounds calling out, "Hari! Hari!"

19 Kānāi Khuṭiyā was dressed as Nanda, and Jagannātha Māhāti had become Yaśodā, the Queen of Vraja.

20 King Pratāparudra himself was there, with Kāśī Miśra, Sārvabhauma and Tulasī, the temple *paḍichā*.

21 With them all the Lord danced joyfully, and everyone was drenched in yogurt, milk and turmeric water.

22 Advaita said, “I am telling You the truth — don’t be angry. Only if You can twirl a staff will I know You are a cowherd.”

23 Then the Lord took a staff and began to twirl it, tossing it into the air again and again and catching it.

24 He twirled the staff over His head, in front, behind, on both sides and even between His feet, and the people laughed to see it.

25 He whirled the staff like a circle of fire traced by a firebrand, and all who saw it were struck with wonder.

26 Nityānanda twirled a staff in the same way. Who can understand the hidden cowherd mood of these two?

27 At Pratāparudra’s order, Tulasī the *paḍichā* came, bringing a cloth that had been offered to Jagannātha.

28 The Lord tied the costly cloth around His head, and the Ācārya and the Lord’s other companions were given it to wear as well.

29 Kānāi Khuṭiyā and Jagannātha, the two of them, in their ecstasy gave away all the wealth they had at home.

30 Seeing this, Mahāprabhu was very pleased and bowed down to the two of them as to His mother and father.

31 In deep ecstasy the Lord returned home. Such were the pastimes of Gaurāṅgasundara.

32 On Vijayā-daśamī, the day of the conquest of Laṅkā, the Lord made the devotees into an army of monkeys.

33 Absorbed in the mood of Hanumān, the Lord took a tree branch, climbed the ramparts of Laṅkā and tore Laṅkā down.

34 In a fit of anger the Lord cried, “Where is that wretch Rāvaṇa? The sinner has carried off the Mother of the world! I will kill him and all his race!”

35 Seeing the Lord’s ecstasy, the people were amazed, and all of them shouted “Jaya! Jaya!” again and again.

36 In the same way they all saw the Rāsa-yātrā, Dīpāvalī and the festival of Utthāna-dvādaśī.

37 One day Mahāprabhu took Nityānanda aside, and the two brothers sat together in seclusion and took counsel.

38 What the two decided no one knew; only later could the devotees guess it from what followed.

39 Then Mahāprabhu called all the devotees and bade them farewell, telling them to go back to Gauḍa.

40 He said to them all, “Come every year: see the Guṇḍicā festival, meet with Me, and then go home.”

41 With respect He gave this order to the Ācārya: “Give devotion to Kṛṣṇa to everyone, down to the *caṇḍālas*.”

42 To Nityānanda He gave this order: “Go to Gauḍa and reveal loving devotion freely, without restraint.

43 To help You I am sending Rāmadāsa, Gadādhara and some others with You.

44 From time to time I will come to You, and, staying unseen, I will watch You dance.”

45 The Lord embraced Śrīvāsa Paṇḍita and, with His arm around his neck, spoke sweet words to him:

46 “I will always dance in the *kīrtana* at your house. You will see it, but no one else will.

47 Give this cloth and all this *prasāda* to My mother. Fall down before her and beg her to forgive My offense.

48 I gave up serving her and took *sannyāsa*. That is not *dharma*: I am destroying My own *dharma*.

49 I am subject to her love, and serving her is My *dharma*. In giving that up I have acted like a madman.

50 A mother does not hold her mad child at fault. Knowing this, My mother is not angry with Me.

51 What use is *sannyāsa* to Me? Love is My real wealth. When I took *sannyāsa*, My mind was deranged.

52 I stay in Nīlācala at her bidding, and from time to time I will come to see her feet.

53 Every day I go and see her feet, but she takes it for a vision and does not believe it is real.

54–55 One day she offered the *śālagrāma* many gifts: *śāli* rice, five or seven vegetable dishes, greens, *ghaṇṭa* of banana flowers, fried *paṭolas* with *nīm* leaves, slices of lemon and ginger, yogurt, milk and sugar candy.

56 She took the *prasāda* on her lap and wept: ‘All these dishes are my Nimāi’s favorites.

57 Nimāi is not here — who will eat them?’ As she thought of Me, her eyes filled with tears.

58 I went at once and ate everything. Seeing the plate empty, she wiped away her tears.

59 ‘Who has eaten the rice and vegetables? Why is the plate empty? Could Bāla-gopāla have eaten all the rice?

60 Or was my mind deluded about it? Or did some animal come and eat it all?

61 Or did I forget to serve the food on the plate?’ Thinking this, she went and looked into the cooking pots.

62 She saw that all the pots were still full of rice and vegetables, and at the sight she was filled with doubt and wonder.

63 She called Īśāna, had the place cleaned and plastered again, and once more offered food to Gopāla.

64 Whenever she cooks something excellent like this, she weeps with longing to feed Me.

65 Her love draws Me there and makes Me eat. Within she feels happy, but outwardly she does not accept it.

66 This happened on this very Vijayā-daśamī. Ask her about it and convince her that it was real.”

67 As He said this, the Lord was overwhelmed; but to send the devotees off He kept His composure.

68 To Rāghava Paṇḍita He spoke tender words: “Your steadfast love has brought Me under your control.

69 Hear, everyone, how he serves Kṛṣṇa. His service is supremely pure, the very best of all.

70 Leaving aside his other offerings, hear about the coconuts. There a coconut sells for five *gaṇḍās*.

71 In his garden hundreds of trees bear fruit by the hundreds of thousands, yet he still asks where the sweetest coconuts are to be had.

72 He pays four *paṇas* for every single fruit and takes pains to have them brought from ten *krośas* away.

73 Every day he has five or seven fruits husked and keeps them immersed in water to make them very cool.

74 At the time of the offering he trims and prepares them again, cuts an opening in the top, and offers them to Kṛṣṇa.

75 Kṛṣṇa drinks the coconut water: sometimes He leaves the fruit empty, sometimes still full of water.

76 When the Paṇḍita sees a fruit emptied of its water, he is delighted. He breaks it open and fills a plate with the pulp.

77 He offers the pulp and meditates outside, and Kṛṣṇa eats the pulp and leaves the vessel empty.

78 Sometimes, after eating the pulp, Kṛṣṇa fills the vessel with pulp again. Then the Paṇḍita's faith grows, and he floats in an ocean of love.

79 One day a servant prepared ten coconuts and brought them to be offered.

80 It was not yet time to offer them; there was a delay, so the servant waited at the door with the plate of fruits in his hand.

81 He touched the wall above the door with his hand and then touched the fruits with the same hand. The Paṇḍita saw it.

82 The Paṇḍita said, "People are always coming and going through this door. The dust from their feet flies up and settles on the wall above it.

83 You put your hand on that wall and then touched the fruits. They are no longer fit for Kṛṣṇa — they have become impure."

84 With these words he threw the fruits over the boundary wall. Such is his pure, loving service: it conquers the world.

85 Then he had other coconuts prepared and offered them with the utmost purity.

86 In the same way, whenever he hears of good bananas, mangoes, oranges or jackfruits in some distant village,

87 he pays a great price, takes pains to have them brought, prepares them with purity and offers them.

88 So too with the greens, roots and vegetables for his dishes, and with flat rice, *huḍuma* and all kinds of sweets;

89 so too with cakes, drinks and sweet rice — all supremely pure and the very best.

90 He offers *kāśamdi*, pickles and many other things, and the best of everything: scents, cloth and ornaments.

91 Such is the incomparable service he renders in love; it is a balm to the eyes of all who see it.”

92 With these words He embraced Rāghava, and in the same way He honored all the devotees.

93 Respectfully He said to Śivānanda Sena, “Please look after Vāsudeva Datta.

94 He is extremely generous: whatever comes to him on any day, he spends that same day and keeps nothing back.

95 He is a householder, and a householder needs to save; without savings he cannot support his family.

96 Let all the income and expenses of his household be in your hands. Be his *sarakhela*, his guardian, and manage his affairs.

97 Every year bring all My devotees to the Guṇḍicā festival, and take care of them all."

98 To the residents of Kulīna-grāma He said respectfully, "Come every year to the festival, and bring silk ropes.

99 Guṇarāja Khān composed the *Śrī Kṛṣṇa-vijaya*, and in it there is a sentence of his that is full of love:

100 'Kṛṣṇa, the son of Nanda, is the Lord of my life.' For this one sentence I have sold Myself into the hands of his descendants.

101 What to speak of you? Even a dog of your village is dear to Me, not to mention anyone else there."

102 Then Rāmānanda and Satyarāja Khān humbly put a question at the Lord's feet:

103 "I am a worldly householder. What should my practice be? Please instruct me with Your own lips — I submit this at Your feet."

104 The Lord said, "Serve Kṛṣṇa, serve the Vaiṣṇavas, and always chant the Name of Kṛṣṇa in *saṅkīrtana*."

105 Satyarāja said, "How am I to recognize a Vaiṣṇava? Tell me who is a Vaiṣṇava — what are his general marks?"

106 The Lord said, "Anyone from whose mouth I hear the Name of Kṛṣṇa even once is worthy of worship — he is the best of all.

107 A single Name of Kṛṣṇa destroys all sins, and through the Name the nine kinds of devotion become complete.

108 The Name does not wait for initiation, *puraścaryā* or any other rule. Simply by touching the tongue it delivers everyone, down to the *caṇḍāla*.

109 As a mere by-product it ends worldly existence; and by attracting the heart it awakens love for Kṛṣṇa.

110 “This *mantra*, the Name of Śrī Kṛṣṇa, draws the liberated and the wise and uproots all sins. Down to the *caṇḍāla*, it is within easy reach of everyone who is not mute, and it holds the wealth of liberation in its power. It does not look in the least for initiation, pious rites or *puraścaryā*: merely by touching the tongue it bears fruit.” (Padyāvalī 29)

111 Therefore anyone in whose mouth is even one Name of Kṛṣṇa is a Vaiṣṇava; show him honor.”

112 From Khaṇḍa came Mukunda dāsa, Śrī Raghunandana and Śrī Narahari — these three were the chief among them.

113 The son of Śacī asked Mukunda dāsa, “Are you the father, and Śrī Raghunandana your son?

114 Or is Raghunandana the father, and you his son? Tell Me for certain, so that My doubt may go.”

115 Mukunda said, “Raghunandana is my father, and I am his son — that is my conviction.

116 All of us have received devotion to Kṛṣṇa from Raghunandana. So Raghunandana is certainly my father.”

117 Hearing this, the Lord said joyfully, “You have spoken rightly: he from whom devotion to Kṛṣṇa comes is the guru.”

118 The Lord delights in telling the glories of His devotees; telling them, He becomes as if five-mouthed.

119 He said to the devotees, “Hear about Mukunda’s love: it is spotless and deep, like pure gold.

120 Outwardly he is a royal physician in the king’s service. Who could know the love within him?

121 One day, on the Muslim king’s high platform, the king was talking with him about medical treatment.

122 Just then a servant brought a fan of peacock feathers and held it over the king’s head.

123 At the sight of the peacock feathers Mukunda was overwhelmed with love and fell from the high platform to the ground.

124 The king thought his royal physician had been killed. He came down himself and brought him back to his senses.

125 The king asked, “Where are you hurt?” Mukunda answered, “I am not badly hurt.”

126 The king asked, “Mukunda, why did you fall?” Mukunda said, “O king, I suffer from epilepsy.”

127 But the king was very shrewd and understood it all: he came to regard Mukunda as a great perfected soul.

128 Raghunandana serves in Kṛṣṇa’s temple. At its door there is a pond, and above its bathing steps

129 stands a *kadamba* tree that blossoms all twelve months of the year; every day it gives two flowers to adorn Kṛṣṇa.

130 Again He spoke sweet words to Mukunda: “Your duty is to earn wealth in keeping with *dharma*.

131 Raghunandana’s duty is to serve Kṛṣṇa; his mind turns to nothing but serving Kṛṣṇa.

132 And let Narahari stay with My devotees. You three must always carry out these three duties.”

133 Showing His mercy to the two brothers, Sārvabhauma and Vidyā-vācaspati, the Lord said:

134 “Kṛṣṇa is now manifest in the form of wood and in the form of water. Through seeing Him and through bathing in Him, He liberates living beings.

135 As the Dāru-brahma, Brahman in the form of wood, He is Śrī Puruṣottama Himself; and the Bhāgīrathī is the Jala-brahma, Brahman in the form of water.

136 Sārvabhauma, worship the Dāru-brahma. Vācaspati, serve the Jala-brahma.”

137 The Lord embraced Murāri Gupta and spoke of his steadfast devotion. Listen, devotees!

138 “In the past I tried again and again to win him over: ‘Gupta, the son of the king of Vraja is supremely sweet.

139 Kṛṣṇa is the Lord Himself, the source of all His portions and the shelter of all. He is pure, spotless love, and every *rasa* is found in Him.

140 He is a mine filled with the jewels of every good quality. He is clever, skillful and composed — the crown of all who relish *rasa*.

141 Kṛṣṇa's nature is sweet, and His pastimes are sweet; cleverness and skill fill the *rasa* of His play.

142 Worship that Kṛṣṇa and take shelter of Him. Apart from Kṛṣṇa, no other worship can win the mind.'

143 Hearing such words from Me again and again, out of regard for Me his mind turned a little.

144 He said to Me, 'I am Your servant. I carry out Your orders; I am not independent.'

145 With these words he went home. That night, as he thought it over, the idea of giving up Raghunātha left him distraught.

146 'How can I give up the feet of Raghunātha? O Lord, let me die this very night!'

147 So he wept all night long; there was no peace in his mind, and he could not sleep.

148 In the morning he came and clasped My feet, and, weeping and weeping, he submitted this to Me:

149 'I have sold my head at the feet of Raghunātha. I cannot take my head back, and my heart is in anguish.

150 I cannot give up the feet of Śrī Raghunātha, yet that means breaking Your order. What am I to do?

151 So, O merciful Lord, show me this mercy: let me die before You, and let my dilemma end.'

152 "Hearing this, I felt great joy at heart. Then I raised him up and embraced him.

153 " 'Excellent, excellent, Gupta! Your worship is firm indeed: even My words did not shake your mind.

154 " 'This is the love for the Lord's feet that I want in a servant: even if the Lord tries to make him leave them, he cannot let go of those feet.

155 " 'It was to learn how steadfast you are that I urged you again and again.

156 " 'You are Hanumān himself, the servant of Śrī Rāma. Why would you ever give up His lotus feet?'

157 "This is that same Murāri Gupta, who is as dear to Me as My life. When I hear his humility, My heart breaks."

158 Then the Lord embraced Vāsudeva and began to describe his qualities as if He had a thousand mouths.

159 Hearing his own qualities praised, Vāsudeva Datta felt ashamed. Clasping the Lord's feet, he made a petition:

160 "O Lord, You have descended to deliver the world. Please grant me one request.

161 “O merciful Lord, You are able to do anything. If You only wish it, it happens without effort.

162 “My heart breaks to see the suffering of living beings. O Lord, place the sins of all living beings on my head.

163 “Let me take the sins of the living beings and suffer in hell for them. O Lord, cure all living beings of the disease of material existence.”

164 Hearing this, Mahāprabhu’s heart melted. With tears, trembling and a faltering voice, He began to speak.

165 “This is no wonder in you: you are Prahlāda himself. Kṛṣṇa’s grace rests on you in full.

166 “Whatever His servant asks for, Kṛṣṇa makes true. He has no task other than fulfilling His servant’s desire.

167 “You have desired the deliverance of all beings in the universe, so all will be delivered without suffering for their sins.

168 “Kṛṣṇa is not powerless; He holds all power. Why, then, would He make you suffer the fruits of sin?

169 “Anyone whose welfare you desire has become a Vaiṣṇava, and Kṛṣṇa removes all the sins of a Vaiṣṇava.

170 “I worship Govinda, the original Person. To each, from the tiny *indragopa* insect to Indra himself, He grants the fruits that match the bondage of his own karma; but the karma of those who have devotion He burns away.” (Brahma-saṁhitā 5.54)

171 “By your mere wish the universe will be liberated. To liberate everyone is no labour for Kṛṣṇa.

172 “As millions of fruits grow on a single *uḍumbara* tree, so millions of universes float on the waters of the Virajā.

173 “If one of its fruits falls and is lost, the tree does not even notice its loss.

174 “So too, if one universe is liberated, Kṛṣṇa does not take it as even a slight loss.

175 “Kṛṣṇa’s opulence is infinite: Vaikuṇṭha and His other abodes. Their moat is the ocean called the Causal Ocean (*Kāraṇābdhi*).

176 “On it the infinite universes float together with *māyā*, like a pot full of mustard seeds floating in a moat.

177 “No one counts it a loss if one of those mustard seeds is lost; likewise, Kṛṣṇa loses nothing if one universe is lost.

178 “Even if *māyā* herself is destroyed along with all the universes, Kṛṣṇa does not consider it any loss.

179 “It is like the death of a she-goat for the owner of millions of wish-fulfilling cows. What can *māyā* mean to Kṛṣṇa, the Lord of the six opulences?

180 “Glory, glory to You, O unconquered one! Destroy the unborn *māyā*, who has taken up the qualities to bring about faults, for in Yourself You hold all excellences in full. O awakener of all the potencies of moving and unmoving beings, the Vedas describe You sometimes as acting through

māyā and sometimes through Your own potency." (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam 10.87.14)

181 In this way the Lord spoke of the qualities of all the devotees. Then He embraced them all and bade them farewell.

182 The devotees wept at parting from the Lord, and the Lord's heart grew sad at parting from His devotees.

183 Gadādhara Paṇḍita, whom the Lord had settled at Yameśvara, remained near the Lord.

184–185 With Purī Gosāñi (Paramānanda Purī), Jagadānanda, Svarūpa Dāmodara, Dāmodara Paṇḍita, Govinda and Kāśīśvara, the Lord stayed at Nīlācala, and every morning He went to see Jagannātha.

186 One day Sārvabhauma came to the Lord and, with folded hands, made a request.

187 "Now that all the Vaiṣṇavas have gone back to Gauḍa, there is an opportunity to invite You.

188 "Please take Your meals at my house for a whole month." The Lord said, "That is not dharma; I cannot do it."

189 Sārvabhauma said, "Then take Your meals with me for twenty days." The Lord said, "That is not in keeping with a renunciant's dharma."

190 Sārvabhauma said again, "Then fifteen days." The Lord said, "I shall take a meal with you for one day."

191 Then Sārvabhauma clasped the Lord's feet and entreated Him: "Take Your meals with me for ten days."

192 Step by step the Lord brought it down to five days, and He accepted his invitation for five days.

193 Then Sārvabhauma made another request: “Ten *sannyāsīs* are with You.

194 “I have already told You that Purī Gosāñi will take his meals at my house for five days.

195 “Svarūpa Dāmodara is my friend: he will come sometimes with You and sometimes alone.

196 “The other eight *sannyāsīs* will take their meals with me for two days each, one person each day. In this way the month will be filled.

197 “If many *sannyāsīs* come at once, I will not be able to honour them properly and will commit an offence.

198 “You should come to my house alone, with only Your own shadow, and sometimes Svarūpa Dāmodara will come with You.”

199 Receiving the Lord’s sign of consent, Sārvabhauma was delighted, and that same day he invited Mahāprabhu.

200 The Bhaṭṭācārya’s wife, known as Ṣāṭhī’s mother, was a great devotee of the Lord and loved Him like a mother.

201 Coming home, the Bhaṭṭācārya told her the news, and Ṣāṭhī’s mother joyfully began to cook.

202 The Bhaṭṭācārya’s house was well stocked with every provision; whatever greens, fruits and other things were needed, he gathered and brought.

203 The Bhaṭṭācārya himself saw to all the finer points of the cooking, and Ṣāṭhī's mother was skilled and knew the work of cooking well.

204 To the south of the kitchen were two rooms for offering food. In one of them food was offered to Nārāyaṇa in His form as the Śālagrāma.

205 The other room, in a secluded spot, Bhaṭṭa had newly built for Mahāprabhu's meals.

206 It had one door to the outside, for the Lord to enter, and one door from the kitchen, for serving the food.

207 On a whole leaf of the *battiśā-āṭhiyā* banana they heaped out the cooked rice of three *mānas* of grain.

208 The rice was soaked with fragrant yellow ghee, which ran over the leaf on all sides.

209 All around it, row upon row, cups of *keyā* leaves and banana bark were set out, filled with various vegetable dishes.

210 There were ten kinds of greens, a bitter *sukuta* soup with *nim*, a peppery *jhāla*, *chānā-baḍās*, *baḍās* and buttermilk.

211 There was bottle gourd and pumpkin cooked in milk, *vesara* and *lāphrā*, a *ghaṇṭa* of banana flowers, fried banana flowers and various kinds of *śākrā*.

212 There were countless dishes of *baḍīs* made with ripe pumpkin, and *phula-baḍīs*, fruits and roots of many kinds.

213 There was eggplant fried with tender *nim* leaves, *phula-baḍī*, fried *paṭola*, and pumpkin with *mānacāki*.

214 There was a soup of fried urad and mung dāl that put nectar to shame, a sweet-and-sour chutney, *baḍāmla* and other sour dishes — five or six of them.

215 There were *baḍās* of mung and of urad, sweet banana *baḍās*, *kṣīra-puli*, coconut *pulī* and every kind of cake.

216 There were *kāǰi-baḍās*, flat rice in milk and milk *laklakī*. I cannot describe all the cakes that were made.

217 Sweet rice soaked with ghee filled earthen pots, with *cāp̃ā* bananas, thickened milk and mangoes set in it.

218 There was *rasālā*, churned yogurt and countless *sandeśas* — every kind of food known in Gauḍa and Utkala.

219 The Bhaṭṭācārya had all this prepared with faith. On a white wooden seat he spread a fine cloth.

220 On either side stood pitchers of cool, fragrant water, and he placed tulasī buds on the rice and vegetables.

221 He also had *amṛta-guṭikā*, cakes and sweet drinks brought, and he kept all of Jagannātha's *prasāda* apart.

222 At that time Mahāprabhu, having finished His midday duties, came alone, knowing the Bhaṭṭācārya's heart.

223 The Bhaṭṭācārya then washed His feet, and the Lord went into the room to take His meal.

224 Seeing the rice and all the dishes, the Lord was astonished, and with a playful gesture He said to the Bhaṭṭācārya:

225 “All this rice and these dishes are extraordinary! How could they have been cooked within two *praharas*?

226 “Even if a hundred people cooked on a hundred stoves, they could not cook so much food so quickly.

227 “I take it that you have offered this food to Kṛṣṇa, since I see tulasī buds on top of it.

228 “You are fortunate, and your effort has borne fruit: you have offered such a feast to Rādhā and Kṛṣṇa.

229 “The fragrance and colour of the rice are most charming. Rādhā and Kṛṣṇa Themselves have eaten of it.

230 “How can I praise your great fortune enough? I too am fortunate, for I shall receive the remnants.

231 “Take away Kṛṣṇa’s seat and keep it aside, and give Me *prasāda* on a separate plate.”

232 The Bhaṭṭācārya said, “O Lord, do not be astonished. By the potency of Him who will eat it, the feast was made ready.

233 “My wife had no labour in the cooking. He by whose potency the feast was made ready knows how it was done.

234 “Please sit on this very seat and take Your meal.” The Lord said, “This seat of Kṛṣṇa’s is to be worshipped.”

235 Bhaṭṭa said, “The food and the seat are equally *prasāda*. If You will eat the food, what offence can there be in sitting on the seat?”

236 The Lord said, “You are right; this is the command of scripture: the servant relishes all that Kṛṣṇa leaves.

237 “ ‘Adorned with the garlands, scents, clothes and ornaments You have used, and eating Your remnants, we, Your servants, shall surely conquer Your *māyā*.’ (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam 11.6.46)

238 “Still, no one can eat so much food.” Bhaṭṭa said, “I know how much You eat. Eat as much as befits You.

239 “At Nīlācala You eat fifty-two times, and the food of each offering comes in hundreds upon hundreds of loads.

240 “In Dvārakā You eat in the palaces of the sixteen thousand queens, with Your eighteen mothers and in the houses of the Yādavas.

241 “In Vraja You eat twice a day, morning and evening, in the houses of all the cowherds — Your uncles on Your father’s and mother’s side, the husbands of Your aunts and others — and of all Your friends.

242 “At the Govardhana sacrifice You ate heaps upon heaps of food. Compared with that, this food is not even one mouthful.

243 “You are the Lord Himself, and I am a tiny, wretched soul. Please accept this one mouthful of *mādhukarī*.”

244 Hearing this, the Lord smiled and sat down to eat, and Bhaṭṭa joyfully served Him Jagannātha’s *prasāda*.

245 At that time Amogha, the Bhaṭṭācārya’s son-in-law, was there. He was the husband of the Bhaṭṭācārya’s daughter Ṣāṭhī — a man of noble (*kulīna*) family, but a blasphemer.

246 He wanted to watch the Lord eat but could not come in, for the Bhaṭṭācārya stood at the door, stick in hand.

247 But when the Bhaṭṭācārya's attention turned to serving the *prasāda*, Amogha came in, saw the food and began to blaspheme:

248 "This food would satisfy ten or twelve people, and one *sannyāsī* eats so much all by himself!"

249 Hearing this, the Bhaṭṭācārya turned round and looked, and seeing that he had noticed, Amogha fled.

250 The Bhaṭṭācārya took up his stick and ran to beat him, but Amogha got away and he could not catch him.

251 Then the Bhaṭṭācārya came back, cursing and abusing him. Hearing all this reviling, Mahāprabhu began to laugh.

252 Hearing of it, Ṣāṭhī's mother beat her head and breast and cried again and again, "Let Ṣāṭhī become a widow!"

253 Seeing the grief of them both, the Lord consoled them, and to fulfil their wish He ate, well pleased.

254 When the Lord had rinsed His mouth, Bhaṭṭa gave Him mouth fresheners: tulasī buds, cloves and juicy, fragrant cardamom.

255 He smeared fragrant sandalwood paste all over the Lord's body and, falling prostrate, spoke humbly:

256 "I brought You to my house only to have You blasphemed. O Lord, forgive me this offence."

257 The Lord said, “That was not blasphemy; he only spoke plainly. What offence is there in this, either on your part or on his?”

258 With these words Mahāprabhu went home, and the Bhaṭṭācārya went with Him to His residence.

259 Falling at the Lord’s feet, he reproached himself bitterly. The Lord calmed him and sent him home.

260 Returning home, the Bhaṭṭācārya reproached himself and said to Ṣāṭhī’s mother:

261 “To kill the man from whom I have heard blasphemy of Caitanya Gosāñi would be the atonement for that sin.

262 “Or I could give up my own life. But neither is proper, for both bodies are those of brāhmaṇas.

263 “I shall never look on that blasphemer’s face again. I have renounced him, and I shall not speak his name.

264 “Tell Ṣāṭhī to leave him: he has fallen (*patita*). When a husband has fallen, it is proper to give him up.

265 “ ‘One should give up a fallen husband.’ ”

266 That night Amogha fled and hid somewhere, and in the morning he was stricken with cholera.

267 Hearing that Amogha was dying, the Bhaṭṭācārya said, “Providence has come to my aid and done my work for me.

268 “An offence against the Lord bears fruit at once.” So saying, he recited two verses of scripture:

269 “What we would have had to do with great effort, with elephants, horses, chariots and foot soldiers, the Gandharvas have done.” (Mahābhārata, Vana-parva 241.15)

270 “Offence against great souls destroys a man’s life, fortune, fame and dharma, his higher worlds and blessings — all that is good for him.” (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam 10.4.46)

271 Gopīnātha Ācārya went to see the Lord, and the Lord asked him about the Bhaṭṭācārya.

272 The Ācārya said, “The two of them are fasting, and Amogha is dying of cholera.”

273 Hearing this, the merciful Lord came running. Placing His hand on Amogha’s chest, He said:

274 “This heart of a brāhmaṇa is pure by nature; it is a fit place for Kṛṣṇa to sit.

275 “Why have you seated the *caṇḍāla* of envy here? You have made this supremely pure place impure.

276 “By Sārvabhauma’s company your impurity has been destroyed, and when the taint is gone, a soul takes the name of Kṛṣṇa.

277 “Get up, Amogha! Take the name of Kṛṣṇa, and Bhagavān will soon show you His mercy.”

278 Hearing this, Amogha rose up crying, “Kṛṣṇa! Kṛṣṇa!” and, mad with love, began to dance.

279 Trembling, tears, hair standing on end, stupor, perspiration and a faltering voice appeared in him, and seeing these waves of love, the Lord smiled.

280 Clasping the Lord’s feet, he humbly entreated Him: “O merciful Lord, forgive my offence.

281 “With this wretched mouth I blasphemed You!” Saying this, he began to slap his own cheeks.

282 He slapped himself until his cheeks were swollen. Then Gopīnātha Ācārya seized his hands and stopped him.

283 The Lord consoled him, touching his body: “Because you are related to Sārvabhauma, you are dear to Me.

284 “Even the servants, maids and dogs in Sārvabhauma’s house are dear to Me — what to speak of others.

285 “There is no offence left in you. Take the name of Kṛṣṇa.” With these words the Lord went to Sārvabhauma’s house.

286 Seeing the Lord, Sārvabhauma clasped His feet. The Lord embraced him and sat down.

287 The Lord said, “Amogha is a child. What fault is there in him? Why are you fasting, and why are you angry?

288 “Get up, bathe and go to see Jagannātha’s face. Then come back quickly and eat; that will make Me happy.

289 “I shall sit here until you have brought *prasāda* and honoured it.”

290 Clasping the Lord’s feet, Bhaṭṭa said, “Amogha would have died. Why did You bring him back to life?”

291 The Lord said, “Amogha is a child; he is your son. A father does not hold his child’s faults against him, for he is his protector.

292 “Now he has become a Vaiṣṇava, and his offence is gone. Now show him your favour.”

293 Bhaṭṭa said, “Go, O Lord, to see Jagannātha. I shall bathe and be back here at once.”

294 The Lord said, “Gopīnātha, stay right here. When he has honoured the *prasāda*, bring Me word.”

295 With these words the Lord went to see Jagannātha, and Bhaṭṭa bathed, took *darśana* and ate.

296 That same Amogha became the Lord’s exclusive devotee. He would dance in love and chant the name of Kṛṣṇa, deeply at peace.

297 Such are the wonderful pastimes of the son of Śacī: whoever sees or hears of them is struck with wonder.

298 Thus the Lord enjoyed the pastime of eating at Bhaṭṭa’s house, and in it He revealed many wonderful deeds.

299 This is the story of the Lord’s meal in Sārvabhauma’s house, in which Sārvabhauma’s love became known,

300 and the love of Ṣāṭhī's mother, and the grace of the Lord, by which He forgave an offence because of the offender's relation to His devotee.

301 Whoever hears this pastime with faith will soon attain the feet of Śrī Caitanya.

302 Praying at the feet of Śrī Rūpa and Śrī Raghunātha, I, Kṛṣṇadāsa, narrate the *Caitanya-caritāmṛta*.